

CRUSTS OR FLAKY SKIN

Check if the patient needs urgent attention ↗ 67.

Are there crusts or flaky skin?

Crusts

Blisters which dry to form yellow crusts often around mouth or nose. May complicate insect bites, scabies or skin trauma.



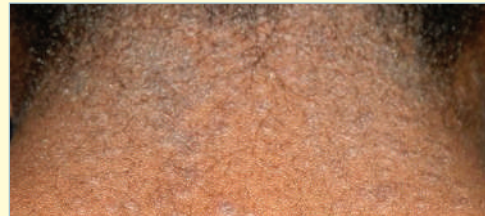
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Impetigo likely

- Impetigo is contagious:
 - Advise to avoid close contact with others and sharing of towels, and to keep nails short.
 - Advise patient and household contacts to wash with soap and water twice a day.
- Apply **povidone iodine 5%** cream or **povidone iodine 10%** ointment to lesions 8 hourly.
- Give **flucloxacillin** 500mg 6 hourly or **cefalexin** 500mg 6 hourly for 5 days. If severe penicillin allergy¹, give instead **azithromycin** 500mg daily for 3 days.
- If not completely resolved, repeat antibiotic course.
- If sores have been present for > 1 week, check urine dipstick.
- Refer if:
 - No better after 2nd course of antibiotics
 - If ≥ 1+ blood on urine dipstick or little/no urine.
 - Swelling of face or limbs.

Flaky skin

Red/pink scaly patches with fine, greasy scales. Usually on scalp, between eyebrows, in nose folds, behind ears, in axillae, groin, under breasts.

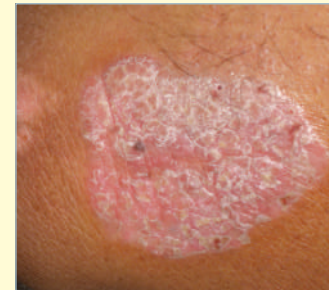


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Seborrhoeic dermatitis likely

- If extensive, test for HIV ↗ 110.
- If on scalp ↗ 80.
- Advise patient to avoid scratching, keep nails short and to avoid scented soap.
- Apply **hydrocortisone 1%** cream twice a day. Once improved, reduce to once or twice a week as needed.
- If poor response or severe, apply instead **betamethasone 0.1%** ointment once a day for 7 days (avoid face, neck and creases).
- If no response within 3 months, refer.

Well-defined, raised plaques covered with silvery scale. Often on knees, elbows, lower back, scalp. May have pitted nails.



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Psoriasis likely

- Refer to specialist to confirm diagnosis.
- While waiting for appointment:
 - Moisturise skin with **emulsifying ointment (UE)** twice a day.
 - Apply **betamethasone 0.1%** ointment twice a day. Once improving, apply instead **hydrocortisone 1%** cream twice a day, then reduce to once a day. Stop as soon as better or apply **liquor picis carbonis (LPC) BP 5%** ointment once a day.
- Encourage to expose skin to sunlight before 10am or after 3pm for up to 30 minutes per day.

Patches of dry, scaly, itchy skin on wrists, ankles, inside elbows or behind knees.



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Eczema likely Manage ↗ 69.

¹History of angioedema, anaphylaxis or urticaria.